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Verifying the trustworthiness of web applications

Abstract

This disclosure relates to verifying the trustworthiness of web applications. In one aspect, a method includes obtaining, by a browser of a client device, an electronic resource comprising code for a web application. The browser renders the electronic resource, including processing the code of the web application. The code causes the browser to initiate a request to a remote server. In response to processing the code, the request is generated and modified to include at least a portion of an integrity element for the web application. The modified request is sent to the remote server. A response to the request is received from the remote server. The response is based on the remote server verifying that the web application is trustworthy using the integrity element. Data is displayed based on the response.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is a National Stage Application under 35 U.S.C. § 371 and claims the benefit of International Application No. PCT/US2021/014118, filed Jan. 20, 2021, the entirety of which is incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) This specification is related to web application security.

BACKGROUND

(3) Web applications, which are also referred to as web apps, are applications that run within web browsers. A web application can be constructed using scripts, Hypertext Markup Language (HTML), Cascading Style Sheets (CS S), and/or other web technologies. Web applications

typically interact with a corresponding web server by sending requests, e.g., Hypertext Transfer Protocol HTTP requests.

SUMMARY

(4) In general, one innovative aspect of the subject matter described in this specification can be embodied in methods that include obtaining, by a browser of a client device, an electronic resource comprising code for a web application; rendering, by the browser, the electronic resource, including processing the code of the web application, wherein the code causes the browser to initiate a request to a remote server; in response to processing the code: generating the request; modifying the request to include at least a portion of an integrity element for the web application; and sending the modified request to the remote server; receiving, from the remote server, a response to the request based on the remote server verifying that the web application is trustworthy using the integrity element; and displaying data based on the response. Other implementations of this aspect include corresponding apparatus, systems, and computer programs, configured to perform the aspects of the methods, encoded on computer storage devices.

(5) These and other implementations can each optionally include one or more of the following features. In some aspects, modifying the request to include the integrity element comprises inserting the portion of the integrity element into a header of the request.

(6) In some aspects, the electronic resource includes the integrity element. Some aspects can include, in response to processing the code, verifying, by the browser, that the web application is trustworthy based at least in part on the code and the integrity element for the web application. The request can be generated in response to verifying that the web application is trustworthy. The integrity element for the web application can include an integrity attribute specifying (i) a cryptographic hash function and (ii) a trusted cryptographic hash calculated using the cryptographic hash function and trusted code of the web application.

(7) Verifying, by the browser, that the web application is trustworthy based at least in part on the code and the integrity element for the web application can include calculating, by the browser and using the cryptographic hash function, a cryptographic hash of the code for the web application obtained by the browser; determining that the calculated cryptographic hash matches the trusted cryptographic hash by comparing the calculated cryptographic hash to the trusted cryptographic hash; and verifying, by the browser, that the web application is trustworthy in response to determining that the calculated cryptographic hash matches the trusted cryptographic hash. The portion of the integrity element can include the trusted cryptographic hash.

(8) In some aspects, the integrity element includes a signed approval element comprising a set of integrity data and a digital signature generated based on the set of integrity data. The set of integrity data can include a trusted cryptographic hash calculated using a cryptographic hash function and trusted code of the web application, an identify of a trusted signer, and a timestamp indicating a time at which the digital signature is generated. The portion of the integrity element can include the set of integrity data and the digital signature.

(9) In some aspects, modifying the request includes inserting, into the request, data identifying a context in which the code is embedded. The data identifying the context in which the code is embedded includes at least one of (i) attributes of a frame of the electronic resource in which the code is embedded or a cryptographic hash of the attributes of the frame.

(10) In some aspects, the integrity element includes a digital signature of a web package that includes components of the web application and data identifying the web package. The integrity element for the web application can include an integrity attribute specifying (i) a cryptographic hash function and (ii) a trusted cryptographic hash calculated using the cryptographic hash function and a trusted asset of the web application. The trusted asset can include an image, logo, or other asset of the web application.

(11) When a web application sends a request, e.g., an HTTP request to a server, e.g., a web server, the entity that owns or operates the server may want the server to evaluate the trustworthiness of

the calling web application. For example, the entity may want to confirm that the code initiating the request was served by the intended domain, that the code has not been modified, and that extensions are not changing the code's behavior. The entity may also want the server to understand and/or respond to the presence of and context of frames, e.g., iframes, in which the code is embedded. This can ensure that the web application is not being used fraudulently and/or that the code of the web application has not been modified.

(12) The subject matter described in this specification can be implemented in particular embodiments so as to realize one or more of the following advantages. The trustworthiness of web applications can be verified by a web server prior to providing a response to a request initiated by the web application to ensure that the response is being provided to a trustworthy web application rather than a modified, fraudulent, and/or malicious version of the web application. A chain of trust can be established for the web application, the browser in which the web application is rendered, and the client device on which the browser is running, which ensures that all components involved in generating and transmitting the request are trustworthy and not fraudulent or compromised. This ensures the integrity of the information in the request, and ensures that responses to the requests are not being used for fraudulent or malicious purposes.

(13) The techniques for verifying the trustworthiness of web applications described in this document can reduce the amount of time required to perform the verification. For example, using, as integrity elements, signed approval elements that include digital signatures for sets of integrity information, the verification of a web application can be performed by a server in less than 0.15 milliseconds (ms). This enables the verification to be used in speed critical applications, such as providing content in response to a request or user interaction with an electronic resource, e.g., web page, that includes the web application. Providing quick responses also prevents errors from occurring within the web applications, e.g., due to waiting for a response from a server that is taking too long to complete a verification process.

(14) By having web applications securely convey their trustworthiness to the web server, the web server can verify the trustworthiness of the web applications without limiting developers' capability to develop web applications and without degrading user's experience with legitimate web applications.

(15) Various features and advantages of the foregoing subject matter is described below with respect to the figures. Additional features and advantages are apparent from the subject matter described herein and the claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 shows an environment in which the trustworthiness of web applications is verified.
- (2) FIG. 2 shows an environment in which web applications with integrity elements are uploaded for distribution to client devices.
- (3) FIG. 3 shows an environment in which web applications with integrity elements are uploaded for distribution to client devices.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a swim lane diagram that illustrates an example process for verifying the trustworthiness of a web application.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a flow diagram that illustrates an example process for verifying the trustworthiness of an application and providing a response in response to verifying the trustworthiness of the web application.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of an example computer system.
- (7) Like reference numbers and designations in the various drawings indicate like elements.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) In general, this document describes systems and techniques for verifying the trustworthiness of web applications. A web server can verify the trustworthiness of a web application in response to receiving a request from the web application. In this way, the web server can ensure that the web application is trustworthy prior to providing a response to the request.

(9) The server can verify the trustworthiness of a web application using an integrity element included with the request. The integrity element can have different forms or data structures, but each one can be used to verify the trustworthiness of the web application alone or in combination with other information. For example, the server can also verify that the request originated from an appropriate origin, which can be the domain of the electronic resource (e.g., web page) that includes the web application. In another example, the server can verify that the context in which the web application is rendered is an appropriate or common context. Although the techniques are described in terms of a web browser and web applications, similar techniques can be used to verify the integrity of embedded applications in other contexts, e.g., in native applications developed for particular platforms or particular devices.

(10) FIG. 1 shows an environment **100** in which the trustworthiness of web applications is verified. The example environment **100** includes a data communication network **105**, such as a local area network (LAN), a wide area network (WAN), the Internet, a mobile network, or a combination thereof. The network **105** connects the client devices **110**, content management systems **120**, and web servers **130**. Although referred to as web servers, the web servers **130** can be implemented using other types of computing systems but are referred to as web servers that interact with web applications embedded in electronic resources.

(11) A client device **110** is an electronic device that is capable of communicating over the network **105**. Example client devices **110** include personal computers, mobile communication devices, e.g., smart phones, and other devices that can send and receive data over the network **105**. A client device can also include a digital assistant device that accepts audio input through a microphone and outputs audio output through speakers. The digital assistant can be placed into listen mode (e.g., ready to accept audio input) when the digital assistant detects a “hotword” or “hotphrase” that activates the microphone to accept audio input. The digital assistant device can also include a camera and/or display to capture images and visually present information. The digital assistant can be implemented in different forms of hardware devices including, a wearable device (e.g., watch or glasses), a smart phone, a speaker device, a tablet device, or another hardware device. A client device can also include a digital media device, e.g., a streaming device that plugs into a television or other display to stream videos to the television, a gaming system, or a virtual reality system.

(12) A client device **110** typically includes applications, such as web browsers **111** and/or native applications, to facilitate the sending and receiving of data over the network **105**. A native application is an application developed for a particular platform or a particular device (e.g., mobile devices having a particular operating system).

(13) A content management system **120** can include servers that provide electronic resources in response to requests received from browsers **111**. The content management system **120** can host websites of a publisher. A website includes one or more electronic resources associated with a domain name and hosted by one or more servers of the content management system **120**. An example website is a collection of web pages formatted in hypertext markup language (HTML) that can contain text, images, and/or multimedia content. An electronic resource can also include one or more web applications constructed with scripts, HTML, Cascading Style Sheets (CSS), browser extensions, or other web technology. Each website is maintained by a content publisher, which is an entity that controls, manages and/or owns the website.

(14) A resource is any data that can be provided by the publisher over the network **105**, and can be associated with a resource address. Resources include HTML pages, word processing documents, and portable document format (PDF) documents, images, video, and feed sources, to name just a few. The resources can include content, such as words, phrases, pictures, and so on, and may

include embedded information (such as metadata and hyperlinks) and/or embedded instructions (e.g., scripts).

(15) The web servers **130** can receive and respond to requests from web applications. For example, some functionality of a web application can involve tasks performed at a remote server that is remote from the client device **110** on which the web application is being processed, e.g., being executed. The web application can initiate a request and the browser **111** can send the request to the web server(s) **130** corresponding to the web application. The web servers **130** can interact with application servers that perform the tasks and provide a response to the browser **111** which, in turn, provides a response to the web application. The web application can then render content within the browser based on the response, display data verifying that an action was performed in response to the request, or perform some other action based on the response.

(16) The web servers **130** can verify the trustworthiness of a web application that initiated a request prior to acting on the request and/or providing a response to the request. For example, the web servers can ensure that the web application has at least a threshold trustworthiness based on one or more integrity signals. An example process for verifying the trustworthiness of a web application is described below with reference to stages A-E.

(17) In some implementations, the web servers **130** can establish a chain of trust that indicates the trustworthiness of two or more of: the web application, the trustworthiness of the browser **111** that is processing/rendering the web application, and the trustworthiness of the client device **110** on which the web browser is being executed. For example, the web server **130** can receive, from the browser **111** data that can be used to verify the trustworthiness of each of these components. If the web server **130** cannot verify the trustworthiness of any one of the components, the web server **130** can elect to not respond to the request, or determine a modified response that is different from the response that the web application would provide if all components were verified as being trustworthy.

(18) During stage A, the browser obtains an electronic resource **122** from a content management system **120**. The electronic resource **122**, which can be a web page, includes code **124** and an integrity element **126**. The code **124** can be code of a web application included in, e.g., embedded in, the electronic resource **122**. For example, the code **124** can include scripts included between script tags, e.g., `<script src="url"></script>`, in an HTML document. Some electronic resources can include multiple scripts or other code elements for one or more web applications.

(19) The electronic resource **122** can include a respective integrity element **126** for each of one or more code elements. For example, if the web application includes multiple scripts, the electronic resource **122** can include a respective integrity element **126** for each individual script.

(20) Although the techniques described in this document are described largely in terms of integrity elements for code of a web application, the same or similar techniques can be used to verify that other assets of the web application have not been modified and therefore the web application is trustworthy. For example, the electronic resource **122** can include a respective integrity element for each asset, e.g., each code element, each image, each logo, etc. By verifying that code elements (e.g., HTML, CSS, scripts), images and/or logos have not been modified, the web server **130** can verify that the look and feel of the web application has not been modified.

(21) The integrity element **126** can take one of various forms described in this document. In one example, the integrity element can include, or be in the form of, an integrity attribute that specifies a cryptographic hash function and a trusted cryptographic hash calculated using the cryptographic hash function and trusted code of the web application. This trusted cryptographic hash is an expected hash value that should result from the browser **111** and/or the web server **130** calculating a hash value using the cryptographic hash function and the actual code **124** received with the electronic resource **122**. The cryptographic hash for a code element can be referred to as the identity of the code element. The cryptographic hash function can be one or various hash functions of choice, such as, for example, SHA256.

(22) In another example, the integrity element for the code **124** can include a signed approval element that includes a set of integrity data and a digital signature generated based on the set of integrity data. The signed approval element can be generated by a trusted signer, as described below with reference to FIG. 3. The set of integrity data can include a trusted cryptographic hash calculated using a cryptographic hash function and trusted code of the web application, an identity of the trusted signer, and a timestamp indicating a time at which the digital signature is generated. The identity of the trusted signer can be based on a domain of the trusted signer, e.g., an eTLD+1 of the trusted signer domain. The eTLD+1 is the effective top-level domain (eTLD) plus one level more than the public suffix. An example eTLD+1 is “example.com” where “.com” is the top-level domain.

(23) The timestamp can indicate a date and/or time at which the digital signature is generated. For example, the timestamp can be the date, a date and hour, or higher resolution (e.g., to the second). In another example, the timestamp can indicate a number of days since epoch or some specified date. The digital signature can be generated using a private key of the trusted signer and the set of integrity data so that any modification of the set of data can be detected if verification of the digital signature fails using the public key corresponding to the private key.

(24) In another example, the web application can be distributed as a web package that bundles all assets (e.g., HTML, CSS, scripts, images, etc.) of the web application into a single file that can be easily distributed. Such files can be digitally signed by the developer of the web application or another appropriate entity. This enables the web server to validate the actual identity of the code **124** delivered by the web package in addition to its origin. In this example, the integrity element can be the digital signature of the web package.

(25) During stage B, the browser **111** renders the electronic resource **122**. When the browser **111** renders the code **124** of the web application, the code **124** can instruct the browser **111** to send a request **112** to the web server **130** in stage C. In implementations in which the integrity element includes a trusted cryptographic hash of trusted code of the application, the browser **111** can optionally verify that the code **124** included in the electronic resource **122** is trustworthy prior to generating and sending the request. This can include extracting the identity of the cryptographic hash function and the trusted cryptographic hash from the integrity element **126**, calculating a cryptographic hash of the code **124** included in the electronic resource **122** with the extracted cryptographic hash function, and comparing the calculated cryptographic hash to the trusted cryptographic hash. If the two hashes match, the trustworthiness of the code **124** is successfully verified and the browser **111** can generate and send the request. If the two hashes do not match, the browser **111** can block the request **112**, e.g., not send the request **112**, or the browser **111** can stop rendering the code **124** of the web application.

(26) In stage C, the browser **111** generates the request **112** and transmits the request **112** to the web server **130** corresponding to the web application. Generating the request **112** can include modifying the request **112** to include the integrity element **126** or at least a portion of the integrity element **126** for the code **124**, e.g., the individual code element that initiated the request. For example, the browser **111** can modify the request **112** to include the cryptographic hash of the code **124** of the web application that initiated the request **112**, to include the signed approval element for the code **124** that initiated the request, or to include the digital signature of the web package, depending on the form of the integrity element **126**. In implementations in which the integrity element includes a cryptographic hash of the code **124**, the browser **111** can send this cryptographic hash even when the electronic resource **122** does not include an integrity attribute that includes the trusted cryptographic hash. Instead, the browser can generate and send a cryptographic hash of the code **124** using the appropriate cryptographic hash function, e.g., a pre-specified hash function or a hash function identified by the electronic resource **111** or the code **124**. In this way, the web server can still know the identity of the code **124** that generated the request **112** and use the cryptographic hash of the code **124** to determine whether the code **124** is trustworthy.

(27) If the electronic resource includes the integrity attribute and assuming the trusted cryptographic hash of the integrity attribute matches the cryptographic hash computed by the browser **111**, the browser **111** can insert either of the two hash values into the request **112**. As shown in FIG. **1**, the browser **111** can insert the integrity element, or the portion of the integrity element into the header **114** of an HTTP request that also includes a body **116** with additional information for the request **112**, e.g., the purpose of the request **112**, data to be used in processing the request **112**, etc. As described in more detail below, the browser **111** can insert additional integrity information into the request **112**, e.g., into the header **114**, that can be used to verify the trustworthiness of the web application.

(28) During stage D, the web server **130** processes the request **112**. Processing the request **112** can include verifying the trustworthiness of the web application that initiated the request. The techniques in which the web server **130** verifies the request **112** can vary based on the form of the integrity element **126** and/or the additional integrity information included in the request **112**. Example techniques for verifying the trustworthiness of a web application are described in more detail below.

(29) During stage E, the web server **130** can respond, or not respond, to the request **112** based on whether the trustworthiness of the web application is verified successfully. If the trustworthiness of the web application is verified successfully, the web server **130** can process the request **112** and respond to the request **112** in a normal manner, e.g., by providing content for display at the browser **111**. If the trustworthiness of the web application is not verified successfully, the web server **130** can ignore the request **112** or respond to the browser **111** with a response indicating that the web application **111** is not trustworthy. If the browser **111** receives a response, the browser **111** can display content at the display of the client device **110** based on the response.

(30) FIG. **2** shows an environment **200** in which web applications with integrity elements are uploaded for distribution to client devices. In this example, the integrity element includes an integrity attribute that specifies a cryptographic hash function and a trusted cryptographic hash calculated using the cryptographic hash function and trusted code of the web application.

(31) During stage A, a trusted web application publisher **240** uses a development tool **210** to develop a web application (i.e., web application A). The development tool **210** can be implemented as a computer with software that enables users to develop and publish web applications. For example, the development tool **210** can be a cloud-based or local software development platform. The web application includes code **214**, e.g., scripts, HTML, CSS, etc., that, when executed by a client device, implements the functionality of the web application. The web application can also include other assets, e.g., images, logos, etc. This code **214** can be considered trusted code as it is the original code and has not had an opportunity to be modified by a malicious party. Similarly, the assets can be considered trusted assets. After developing the web application, the web application publisher **240** generates a request **242** that requests that the development tool **210** publish the web application.

(32) During stage B, the development tool **210** calculates a cryptographic hash of the code **214** and/or other assets using a cryptographic hash function. If the web application includes multiple code elements, e.g., multiple scripts, the development tool **210** can calculate a respective cryptographic hash of each code element using the cryptographic hash function. As the cryptographic hash(es) are calculated using trusted code, the cryptographic hash(es) can be referred to as trusted cryptographic hash(es).

(33) The development tool **210** can send, to a trusted code database **230**, a data element **212** for the code **214** and/or other asset. The data element **212** can include a unique identifier **216** for the web application and the cryptographic hash **218** of the code. If the web application includes multiple code elements, the development tool **210** can send a respective data element **212** for each code element. The trusted code database **230** can store trusted cryptographic hashes for code and/or other assets of web applications so that web servers can verify the trustworthiness of the web

applications, as described in more detail below.

(34) The development tool **210** can also update web application A to include an integrity element for the code **214** and/or other asset. In this example, the integrity element is an integrity attribute **246**. The development tool **210** can insert the integrity attribute **246** into the code **214**, resulting in updated code **244**. For example, if the code **214** is one or more scripts, the development tool **210** can update the script tags to include the integrity attribute **246** that specifies the cryptographic hash function and the trusted cryptographic hash. In this example, the development tool **210** can update the code **214** to include, in each script tag of the updated code **244**, the integrity attribute **216** for the script in the script tag. The executable code of the web application can remain the same in the updated web application.

(35) During stage C, the development tool **210** sends the updated web application to a content management system **120** so that the updated web application is available for inclusion in electronic resources. In this way, when an electronic resource includes the updated web application, the electronic resource includes the integrity attribute(s) for the code **244** and/or other assets of the web application. Stages B and C can be completely transparent to the trusted web application publisher **240**.

(36) FIG. 3 shows an environment **300** in which web applications with integrity elements are uploaded for distribution to client devices. In this example, the integrity element includes a signed approval element.

(37) During stage A, a trusted web application publisher **240** uses a development tool **210** to develop a web application (i.e., web application A). The web application includes code **314**, e.g., scripts, HTML, CSS, etc., that, when executed by a client device, implements the functionality of the web application, and/or other assets. This code **314** (i.e., analogous to code **214** in FIG. 2) and/or other assets can be considered trusted as it is the original code or assets and has not had an opportunity to be modified by a malicious party. After developing the web application, the web application publisher **240** generates a request **342** that requests that the development tool **210** publish the web application.

(38) During stage B, the development tool **210** sends the code **314** and/or other assets of the application to a trusted signer **350** for review. The trusted signer **350** can be a third party computer of a trusted third party that evaluates code and/or other assets and, if the code or other assets is/are trustworthy, generates a signed approval element for the code or other assets. The trusted third party can be a party that has expertise in evaluating code, e.g., a computer/network security software company or anti-virus developer, a trusted web application publisher, or an industry regulatory agency, or another appropriate party different from the trusted web application publisher **240** and publishers of electronic resources. This evaluation can include, for example, scanning the code for viruses, spyware, and/or other malware or malicious code. In some implementations, the trusted web application publisher **240** can act as the trusted signer **350** to self-sign the web application.

(39) During stage C, the trusted signer **350** can evaluate each code element (or other asset) of the code **314** and generate a signed approval element for each code element (or other asset) that is deemed trustworthy. The trusted signer **350** can generate a signed approval element for a code element, e.g., script, by calculating a cryptographic hash of the code element using a cryptographic hash function. This cryptographic hash can be the same as the trusted cryptographic hash of the integrity attribute described above. As this cryptographic hash is calculated using the trusted code of the web application, this cryptographic hash can be referred to as a trusted cryptographic hash.

(40) The trusted signer **350** can generate the signed approval element for a code element by generating a data structure, e.g., a composite message, that includes a set of integrity data and a digital signature generated based on the set of integrity data. As described above, the set of integrity data can include the trusted cryptographic hash of the code element, an identity of the trusted signer **350**, and a timestamp indicating a time at which the digital signature is generated. The trusted

signer **350** can generate the digital signature by signing over the set of data using a private key of the trusted signer **350**. The digital signature can later be verified using a public key that corresponds to, e.g., is mathematically linked to, the private key. The trusted signer provides each signed approval element to the development tool **210**.

(41) During stage D, the development tool **210** updates web application A to include, as an integrity element, the signed approval element(s). The development tool **210** can insert the integrity attribute **216** into the code **314**, resulting in updated code **344**. For example, if the code **314** is one or more scripts, the development tool **210** can update the script tags to include a new attribute that includes the signed approval element for the script. In this example, the development tool **210** can update the code **314** to include, in each script tag of the updated code **344**, the signed approval element for the script in an attribute of the script tag. The executable of the web application can remain the same in the updated web application. The signed approval element(s) of the web application can be used to verify the trustworthiness of the web application, as described in more detail below.

(42) The development tool **210** sends the updated web application to a content management system **120** so that the updated web application is available for inclusion in electronic resources. In this way, when an electronic resource includes the updated web application, the electronic resource includes the integrity attribute(s) for the code **344** (i.e., analogous to code **244** in FIG. 2) of the web application. Stages B-D can be completely transparent to the trusted web application publisher **240**.

(43) FIG. 4 is a swim lane diagram that illustrates an example process **400** for verifying the trustworthiness of a web application. Operations of the process **400** can be implemented, for example, by a browser **111** of a client device **110**, a content management system (CMS) **120**, code **124** of a web application and a web server **130**. Operations of the process **400** can also be implemented as instructions stored on one or more computer readable media which may be non-transitory, and execution of the instructions by one or more data processing apparatus can cause the one or more data processing apparatus to perform the operations of the process **400**.

(44) Although the process **400** is described in terms of verifying the trustworthiness of a web application based on code of the application, the process **400** can be used to verify the trustworthiness of the web application based on other assets, e.g., images and/or logos, of the web application. For example, the process **400** can be used to determine whether any of these assets have been modified since an integrity element was generated for the asset. Thus, in the description that follows, the term code can be replaced with asset to refer to other assets of the web application.

(45) The browser **111** obtains an electronic resource (**402**). The browser **111** can obtain the electronic resource from a content management system **120** that hosts websites. For example, the browser **111** can request a web page from the content management system **120** in response to a user interacting with a link to the web page or the user entering a Universal Resource Locator (URL) for the web page into the browser **111**. The electronic resource can include a web application.

(46) The electronic resource can also include, for code of the web application, one or more integrity elements. For example, the electronic resource can include an integrity element for each code element (or other elements, e.g., images/logo) of the web application. As described above, the integrity element can be an integrity attribute, a signed approval element, or a digital signature of a web package.

(47) The browser **111** renders the electronic resource (**404**). The browser **111** can display content of the electronic resource on a display of the client device **110**. To render the electronic resource, the browser **111** can process the electronic resource, e.g., process code of the electronic document. For example, the electronic resource can be an HTML document with HTML code that also includes scripts (or other code) for a web application. When processing the HTML of the electronic resource, the browser **111** can identify code **124** of the application, e.g., within script tags or other appropriate tags of the electronic resource.

(48) The browser **111** verifies the trustworthiness of the code **124** of the web application (**406**). This can be an optional step performed by the browser **111**. For example, some electronic resources may

not include a cryptographic hash of trusted code of the web application. The browser **111** can verify the trustworthiness of the code **124** using an integrity element for the code **124** that is included in the electronic resource. For example, as described above, the integrity element can include a trusted cryptographic hash of the trusted code of the web application. To verify the trustworthiness of the code **124**, the browser **111** can use the same hash function that was used to calculate the trusted cryptographic hash to calculate a cryptographic hash of the actual code of the web application received with the electronic resource. The browser can then compare the trusted cryptographic hash to the calculated cryptographic hash. If the two hashes match, the browser **111** can determine that the code **124** of the web application is trustworthy. If the two hashes do not match, the browser **111** can determine that the code **124** of the web application is not trustworthy. If the code is deemed trustworthy, the browser **111** can process the code and send requests to the web server on behalf of the web application. If the code is determined to not be trustworthy, the browser **111** can decline to process the code and/or decline to send a request to the web server **130** on behalf of the code of the web application. The browser **111** can verify the trustworthiness of each code element of the web application included in the electronic resource.

(49) The browser **111** processes the code of the web application (**408**). For example, the browser **111** can read the code and perform one or more actions based on the code. One such action is generating and sending a request to the web server **130**. The request can be for content based on a user interaction with the web application rendered by the browser **111**.

(50) The code **124** initiates a request (**410**). The code **124** can initiate a request to the web server **130** by instructing the browser **111** to generate and send a request to the web server **130**.

(51) The browser **111** generates the request (**412**). The browser **111** can generate a request that includes data and/or instructions for the web server **130**. For example, the request can include data describing a user interaction with the web application for which a response from the web server **130** is required in order to respond to the user interaction. The request can be an HTTP request.

(52) The browser **111** can modify the request to include the integrity element (or at least a portion of the integrity element) for the code **124** that initiated the request. The browser **111** can insert the integrity element or the portion of the integrity element into the header of the request. If the integrity element is an integrity attribute, the browser **111** can include the trusted cryptographic hash of the trusted code of the application in the request. If the integrity element is a signed approval element, the browser **111** can insert the signed approval element into the request. If the integrity element is a signed web package, the browser can insert the digital signature of the signed web package into the request.

(53) The browser **111** can also insert, into the request, additional integrity information that can be used to verify the trustworthiness of the web application. The additional integrity information can include an origin of the web application. The origin can be the domain of the electronic resource that includes the web application. For example, if the web application is embedded in a web page corresponding to example.com, the origin can be example.com. This enables the web server **130** to verify that the web application is included in an appropriate electronic resource. In some implementations, the origin of the web application can be Universal Resource Identifier (URI) or URL.

(54) The additional integrity information can include data identifying a context for the code **124**. The data identifying the context for the code **124** can include attributes of a frame, e.g., an iframe, of the electronic resource in which the code is nested. For example, a web application can be nested within a particular iframe of a web page. This can be an important signal to establish the trust of the code **124**. For example, the code may commonly be nested within particular iframes. If the code **124** is nested within a rare or new iframe, the web application may not be trustworthy.

(55) The code **124** can instruct the browser **111** to collect this context information and insert the information into the request, e.g., into the header of the request. The information can include the nested iframe elements, e.g., only the value of the src attribute of those elements. In some

implementations, the browser **111** can calculate a cryptographic hash of the context information using a cryptographic hash function and insert the cryptographic hash into the request. In this way, the web server **130** can compare the cryptographic hash to previous cryptographic hashes for the context in which the code **124** was nested.

(56) The browser **111** sends the modified request to the web server **130** (**414**). The web server **130** extracts the integrity element (or the portion of the integrity element included in the request) from the request (**416**). For example, the web server **130** can extract the integrity element from the header of the request. If included in the request, the web server **130** can also extract the context information and/or the origin of the web application.

(57) The web server **130** verifies the trustworthiness of the web application (**418**). The web server **130** can verify the trustworthiness of the web application using the integrity element (or portion thereof) included in the request and, if included in the request, the additional integrity information, e.g., the context information and/or the origin of the web application. The techniques for verifying the trustworthiness of the web application can vary based on the form of the integrity element and the additional integrity information included in the request.

(58) If the integrity element is an integrity attribute specifying a cryptographic hash function and a cryptographic hash, the web server **130** can query a database, e.g., the database **230** of FIG. 2, to determine whether the cryptographic hash matches a trusted cryptographic hash for the web application stored in the database. If the cryptographic hash included in the request matches a trusted cryptographic hash for the web application stored in the database, the web server **130** can determine that the web application is trustworthy. If the cryptographic hash included in the request does not match a trusted cryptographic hash for the web application stored in the database, the web server **130** can determine that the web application is not trustworthy. This signature comparison enables the web server **130** to determine whether the code of the web application has been modified from a trusted version of the code. That is, if the signature verification fails, then the code does not match the trusted code for the application. As described in more detail below, the web server **130** can also consider any additional integrity information in addition to the cryptographic hash in determining whether the web application is trustworthy.

(59) If the integrity element is a signed approval element, the web server **130** can perform multiple steps to determine whether the web application is trustworthy. The web server **130** can determine whether the identity of the signer included in the signed approval element matches a trusted signer, e.g., in a list of trusted signers maintained by the web server **130**. If so, the web application passes this verification step.

(60) The web server **130** can also determine whether the digital signature of the signed approval element is valid. The web server **130** can determine whether the digital signature is valid using the set of data of the signed approval element and a public key corresponding to the private key used to sign the set of data. If the digital signature is valid, it means that the set of data has not changed since the digital signature was generated and, therefore, the web application passes this verification step.

(61) The web server **130** can also determine whether the digital signature was generated within a threshold duration of time of the current time. To do this, the web server **130** can compare the timestamp of the signed approval element to a current time, e.g., the time at which the verification is being performed. If a difference between the current time and the time indicated by the timestamp is within the threshold duration, the web application passes this verification step.

(62) If all of the verification steps succeed for the signed approval element, the web server **130** can determine that the web application is trustworthy. As described in more detail below, the web server **130** can also consider any additional integrity information in addition to the cryptographic hash in determining whether the web application is trustworthy.

(63) Using the signed approval element can have some performance advantages over the use of an integrity attribute. For example, the web server **130** does not have to query a database to determine

whether the cryptographic hash of the integrity element matches a trusted cryptographic hash for the web application. This can prevent the database from becoming a bottleneck, and therefore a source of latency, if many requests are received within a short duration of time.

(64) If the integrity element is a digital signature of a web package, the web server **130** can verify the actual origin of the web application rather than the domain of the electronic resource with which the web application is included. In this example, the request can include the resource locator, e.g., URI or URL, of the web package so that the web server knows the identity of the web package that initiated the request. Using the resource locator, the web server can optionally download the web package to perform additional validations. The digital signature of the web application can be generated by the application publisher, which enables the web server to verify that the web application was distributed by the application publisher.

(65) If the request includes additional integrity information, the web server **130** can determine whether the web application is trustworthy based on a combination of the integrity element and the additional integrity information. If the additional integrity information includes data identifying the origin of the web application, the web server **130** can determine whether the web application was served by an intended domain, e.g., by one of a set of intended domains. For example, a web application for displaying videos may be made available to a set of domains that are allowed to embed video playback within their electronic resources. If the origin identified by the request is not in the set of domains, the web server **130** can determine that the web application is not trustworthy. For example, to be deemed trustworthy, the web server **130** can require that the web application pass the integrity element verification and the origin verification.

(66) If the additional integrity information includes context information, the web server **130** can compare the context information to previously received (or permissible) context information. For example, the context information can include a cryptographic hash of attributes of a frame in which the web application is nested. If this cryptographic hash does not match a cryptographic hash for a known trusted context or a common context for which at least a threshold received requests match, the web server **130** can determine that the web application is not trustworthy. If the cryptographic hash does match a cryptographic hash for a known trusted context or a common context for which at least a threshold received requests match, the web server **130** can determine that the web application is trustworthy, assuming that the integrity element was verified successfully. That is, the web server **130** can require that both the context verification and the integrity element verification succeed in order for the web application to be considered trustworthy.

(67) In some implementations, the web server **130** can verify the integrity element, the origin, and the context in which the web application is nested. If all three verifications pass, the web server **130** can determine that the web application is trustworthy. If any verification fails, the web server **130** can determine that the web application is not trustworthy.

(68) In some implementations, the web server **130** can determine a trustworthiness score based on one or more of the verifications. For example, the web server **130** can determine an individual score for each verification and combine the scores, optionally by weighting each score based on the importance of that verification. In this example, the score can vary based on the trustworthiness of the origin and/or the frequency at which a request is received for the web application from a context that matches the context of the request relative to the frequency at which requests are received for the web application from different contexts. For a web application, each of multiple origins can have a corresponding score based on their trustworthiness as assigned by the publisher of the web application or another entity. The web server **130** can compare the trustworthiness score to a threshold trustworthiness to determine whether the web application is trustworthy. For example, if the trustworthiness score satisfies the trustworthiness threshold, e.g., by meeting or exceeding the trustworthiness threshold, the web server **130** can determine that the web application is trustworthy.

(69) In some implementations, the web server can verify the trustworthiness of the web application,

the browser, and the client device, e.g., prior to responding to the request. For example, the web server can receive a trust token or signed redemption record for the browser and/or the client device. The token or signed redemption record can include a verdict of trustworthiness for the browser **111** and/or client device **110**. The token or signed redemption record can also include a digital signature and/or additional information to ensure that the token or signed redemption record was issued by a trusted party and has not been tampered with since it was issued to the browser **111**.

(70) The web server **130** sends a response to the browser **111** (**420**). The web server **130** can determine an appropriate response based on whether the web application is determined to be trustworthy. If the web application is determined to be trustworthy, the web server **130** can process the request and respond to the request in a normal manner, e.g., by identifying and providing responsive content for display by the browser **111** or by providing verification that the web server **130** completed an action corresponding to the request.

(71) If the web application is determined to not be trustworthy, the web server **130** can ignore the request or send a response to the browser **111** indicating that the web application is not trustworthy and therefore content is not being provided. The web server **130** can also maintain an audit log for web applications. For each request, the web server **130** can store, in the audit log, the integrity element of the request and data indicating whether the web application was classified as trustworthy or not trustworthy. The web server **130** can also store, in the audit log, any additional integrity information received with the request. In some implementations, the web server **130** can store only data (e.g., integrity element, trustworthy classification, and additional integrity information) for requests that are classified as being not trustworthy. The audit log enables the publisher or another party to analyze the web application(s) for fraud or misuse.

(72) The browser **111** sends the response to the code **124** (**422**). In turn, the code **124** of the web application can process the response and perform an action based on the response. For example, the code **124** can cause the browser **111** to display content based on the response or display a message or other confirmation that an action was completed.

(73) FIG. 5 is a flow diagram that illustrates an example process **500** for verifying the trustworthiness of an application and providing a response in response to verifying the trustworthiness of the web application. The example process **500** can be performed by a browser **111** of a client device **110**. Operations of the process **500** can be implemented, for example, by a browser **111** of a client device **110**. Operations of the process **500** can also be implemented as instructions stored on one or more computer readable media which may be non-transitory, and execution of the instructions by one or more data processing apparatus can cause the one or more data processing apparatus to perform the operations of the process **500**.

(74) Although the process **500** is described in terms of verifying the trustworthiness of a web application based on code of the application, the process **500** can be used to verify the trustworthiness of the web application based on other assets, e.g., images and/or logos, of the web application. For example, the process **500** can be used to determine whether any of these assets have been modified since an integrity element was generated for the asset. Thus, in the description that follows, the term code can be replaced with asset to refer to other assets of the web application.

(75) An electronic resource is obtained (**502**). The electronic resource can include code for a web application. For example, the electronic resource can include, as one or more code elements of the web application, one or more scripts. In another example, the web application can be implemented using HTML, CSS, extensions, or another appropriate web technology. The electronic resource can include an integrity element for the code, e.g., for each of one or more individual code elements.

(76) The trustworthiness of the web application is verified (**504**). This can be an optional step performed by the browser **111**. For example, some electronic resources may not include a cryptographic hash of trusted code of the web application. The browser can verify that the web application is trustworthy using the integrity element and the code of the web application. For

example, as described above, the integrity element can include a trusted cryptographic hash of trusted code of the application. Verifying the trustworthiness of the web application can include extracting the identity of the cryptographic hash function (if present) and the trusted cryptographic hash from the integrity element, calculating a cryptographic hash of the code included in the electronic resource, and comparing the calculated cryptographic hash to the trusted cryptographic hash. If the two hashes match, the trustworthiness of the web application is successfully verified.

(77) The electronic resource is rendered (**506**). The browser can render the electronic resource, which can include displaying content of the electronic resource at a display of the client device.

(78) A request is generated (**508**). The browser can generate the request in response to determining that the web application is trustworthy. For example, processing the code of the web application can result in the code initiating a request. The browser can generate a request to a web server on behalf of the web application if the web application is trustworthy.

(79) The request is modified (**510**). In some implementations, the browser can modify the request in a way that is opaque to the code of the web application. The browser can modify the request by inserting the integrity element or at least a portion of the integrity element into the request. The portion can include the trusted cryptographic hash if the integrity element is an integrity attribute. The portion can include the digital signature and the URI/URL of a web package if the integrity element is associated with a web package. If the integrity element is a signed approval element, the browser can insert the signed approval element into the request. The integrity element can be inserted into the header of the request, as described above. The browser can also obtain and insert additional integrity information into the request, as described above.

(80) The request is sent to a remote server (**512**). The browser can send, over a network, the modified request to a web server corresponding to the web application.

(81) A response is received from the remote server (**514**). The web server can verify the trustworthiness of the web application based on the integrity element. If the web application is deemed to be trustworthy, the web server can send a response to the browser.

(82) Data is displayed based on the response (**516**). The browser can pass the response received from the web server to the web application and the web application can process the response and cause the browser to display data based on the processing. This data can include, for example, content generated in response to the request or a verification message that confirms that an action was performed in response to the request.

(83) FIG. 6 is a block diagram of an example computer system **600** that can be used to perform operations described above. The system **600** includes a processor **610**, a memory **620**, a storage device **630**, and an input/output device **640**. Each of the components **610**, **620**, **630**, and **640** can be interconnected, for example, using a system bus **650**. The processor **610** is capable of processing instructions for execution within the system **600**. In some implementations, the processor **610** is a single-threaded processor. In another implementation, the processor **610** is a multi-threaded processor. The processor **610** is capable of processing instructions stored in the memory **620** or on the storage device **630**.

(84) The memory **620** stores information within the system **600**. In one implementation, the memory **620** is a computer-readable medium. In some implementations, the memory **620** is a volatile memory unit. In another implementation, the memory **620** is a non-volatile memory unit.

(85) The storage device **630** is capable of providing mass storage for the system **600**. In some implementations, the storage device **630** is a computer-readable medium. In various different implementations, the storage device **630** can include, for example, a hard disk device, an optical disk device, a storage device that is shared over a network by multiple computing devices (e.g., a cloud storage device), or some other large capacity storage device.

(86) The input/output device **640** provides input/output operations for the system **600**. In some implementations, the input/output device **640** can include one or more of a network interface devices, e.g., an Ethernet card, a serial communication device, e.g., and RS-232 port, and/or a

wireless interface device, e.g., and 802.11 card. In another implementation, the input/output device can include driver devices configured to receive input data and send output data to external devices **660**, e.g., keyboard, printer and display devices. Other implementations, however, can also be used, such as mobile computing devices, mobile communication devices, set-top box television client devices, etc.

(87) Although an example processing system has been described in FIG. 6, implementations of the subject matter and the functional operations described in this specification can be implemented in other types of digital electronic circuitry, or in computer software, firmware, or hardware, including the structures disclosed in this specification and their structural equivalents, or in combinations of one or more of them.

(88) Embodiments of the subject matter and the operations described in this specification can be implemented in digital electronic circuitry, or in computer software, firmware, or hardware, including the structures disclosed in this specification and their structural equivalents, or in combinations of one or more of them. Embodiments of the subject matter described in this specification can be implemented as one or more computer programs, i.e., one or more modules of computer program instructions, encoded on computer storage media (or medium) for execution by, or to control the operation of, data processing apparatus. Alternatively, or in addition, the program instructions can be encoded on an artificially-generated propagated signal, e.g., a machine-generated electrical, optical, or electromagnetic signal, that is generated to encode information for transmission to suitable receiver apparatus for execution by a data processing apparatus. A computer storage medium can be, or be included in, a computer-readable storage device, a computer-readable storage substrate, a random or serial access memory array or device, or a combination of one or more of them. Moreover, while a computer storage medium is not a propagated signal, a computer storage medium can be a source or destination of computer program instructions encoded in an artificially-generated propagated signal. The computer storage medium can also be, or be included in, one or more separate physical components or media (e.g., multiple CDs, disks, or other storage devices).

(89) The operations described in this specification can be implemented as operations performed by a data processing apparatus on data stored on one or more computer-readable storage devices or received from other sources.

(90) The term “data processing apparatus” encompasses all kinds of apparatus, devices, and machines for processing data, including by way of example a programmable processor, a computer, a system on a chip, or multiple ones, or combinations, of the foregoing. The apparatus can include special purpose logic circuitry, e.g., an FPGA (field programmable gate array) or an ASIC (application-specific integrated circuit). The apparatus can also include, in addition to hardware, code that creates an execution environment for the computer program in question, e.g., code that constitutes processor firmware, a protocol stack, a database management system, an operating system, a cross-platform runtime environment, a virtual machine, or a combination of one or more of them. The apparatus and execution environment can realize various different computing model infrastructures, such as web services, distributed computing and grid computing infrastructures.

(91) A computer program (also known as a program, software, software application, script, or code) can be written in any form of programming language, including compiled or interpreted languages, declarative or procedural languages, and it can be deployed in any form, including as a stand-alone program or as a module, component, subroutine, object, or other unit suitable for use in a computing environment. A computer program may, but need not, correspond to a file in a file system. A program can be stored in a portion of a file that holds other programs or data (e.g., one or more scripts stored in a markup language document), in a single file dedicated to the program in question, or in multiple coordinated files (e.g., files that store one or more modules, sub-programs, or portions of code). A computer program can be deployed to be executed on one computer or on multiple computers that are located at one site or distributed across multiple sites and

interconnected by a communication network.

(92) The processes and logic flows described in this specification can be performed by one or more programmable processors executing one or more computer programs to perform actions by operating on input data and generating output. The processes and logic flows can also be performed by, and apparatus can also be implemented as, special purpose logic circuitry, e.g., an FPGA (field programmable gate array) or an ASIC (application-specific integrated circuit).

(93) Processors suitable for the execution of a computer program include, by way of example, both general and special purpose microprocessors. Generally, a processor will receive instructions and data from a read-only memory or a random access memory or both. The essential elements of a computer are a processor for performing actions in accordance with instructions and one or more memory devices for storing instructions and data. Generally, a computer will also include, or be operatively coupled to receive data from or transfer data to, or both, one or more mass storage devices for storing data, e.g., magnetic, magneto-optical disks, or optical disks. However, a computer need not have such devices. Moreover, a computer can be embedded in another device, e.g., a mobile telephone, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a mobile audio or video player, a game console, a Global Positioning System (GPS) receiver, or a portable storage device (e.g., a universal serial bus (USB) flash drive), to name just a few. Devices suitable for storing computer program instructions and data include all forms of non-volatile memory, media and memory devices, including by way of example semiconductor memory devices, e.g., EPROM, EEPROM, and flash memory devices; magnetic disks, e.g., internal hard disks or removable disks; magneto-optical disks; and CD-ROM and DVD-ROM disks. The processor and the memory can be supplemented by, or incorporated in, special purpose logic circuitry.

(94) To provide for interaction with a user, embodiments of the subject matter described in this specification can be implemented on a computer having a display device, e.g., a CRT (cathode ray tube) or LCD (liquid crystal display) monitor, for displaying information to the user and a keyboard and a pointing device, e.g., a mouse or a trackball, by which the user can provide input to the computer. Other kinds of devices can be used to provide for interaction with a user as well; for example, feedback provided to the user can be any form of sensory feedback, e.g., visual feedback, auditory feedback, or tactile feedback; and input from the user can be received in any form, including acoustic, speech, or tactile input. In addition, a computer can interact with a user by sending documents to and receiving documents from a device that is used by the user; for example, by sending web pages to a web browser on a user's client device in response to requests received from the web browser.

(95) Embodiments of the subject matter described in this specification can be implemented in a computing system that includes a back-end component, e.g., as a data server, or that includes a middleware component, e.g., an application server, or that includes a front-end component, e.g., a client computer having a graphical user interface or a Web browser through which a user can interact with an implementation of the subject matter described in this specification, or any combination of one or more such back-end, middleware, or front-end components. The components of the system can be interconnected by any form or medium of digital data communication, e.g., a communication network. Examples of communication networks include a local area network ("LAN") and a wide area network ("WAN"), an inter-network (e.g., the Internet), and peer-to-peer networks (e.g., ad hoc peer-to-peer networks).

(96) The computing system can include clients and servers. A client and server are generally remote from each other and typically interact through a communication network. The relationship of client and server arises by virtue of computer programs running on the respective computers and having a client-server relationship to each other. In some embodiments, a server transmits data (e.g., an HTML page) to a client device (e.g., for purposes of displaying data to and receiving user input from a user interacting with the client device). Data generated at the client device (e.g., a result of the user interaction) can be received from the client device at the server.

(97) While this specification contains many specific implementation details, these should not be construed as limitations on the scope of any inventions or of what may be claimed, but rather as descriptions of features specific to particular embodiments of particular inventions. Certain features that are described in this specification in the context of separate embodiments can also be implemented in combination in a single embodiment. Conversely, various features that are described in the context of a single embodiment can also be implemented in multiple embodiments separately or in any suitable subcombination. Moreover, although features may be described above as acting in certain combinations and even initially claimed as such, one or more features from a claimed combination can in some cases be excised from the combination, and the claimed combination may be directed to a subcombination or variation of a subcombination.

(98) Similarly, while operations are depicted in the drawings in a particular order, this should not be understood as requiring that such operations be performed in the particular order shown or in sequential order, or that all illustrated operations be performed, to achieve desirable results. In certain circumstances, multitasking and parallel processing may be advantageous. Moreover, the separation of various system components in the embodiments described above should not be understood as requiring such separation in all embodiments, and it should be understood that the described program components and systems can generally be integrated together in a single software product or packaged into multiple software products.

(99) Thus, particular embodiments of the subject matter have been described. Other embodiments are within the scope of the following claims. In some cases, the actions recited in the claims can be performed in a different order and still achieve desirable results. In addition, the processes depicted in the accompanying figures do not necessarily require the particular order shown, or sequential order, to achieve desirable results. In certain implementations, multitasking and parallel processing may be advantageous.

Claims

1. A computer-implemented method comprising: obtaining, by a browser of a client device, an electronic resource comprising code for a web application; rendering, by the browser, the electronic resource, including processing the code of the web application, wherein the code causes the browser to initiate a request to a remote server; in response to processing the code: generating the request; modifying the request to include at least a portion of an integrity element for the web application; and sending the modified request to the remote server; receiving, from the remote server, a response to the request based on the remote server verifying that the web application is trustworthy using the integrity element; and displaying data based on the response, wherein the integrity element comprises a signed approval element comprising a set of integrity data and a digital signature generated based on the set of integrity data, wherein the set of integrity data comprises: a trusted cryptographic hash calculated using a cryptographic hash function and trusted code of the web application; an identity of a trusted signer; and a timestamp indicating a time at which the digital signature is generated, wherein the portion of the integrity element comprises the set of integrity data and the digital signature.

2. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein modifying the request to include the integrity element comprises inserting the portion of the integrity element into a header of the request.

3. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein the electronic resource comprises the integrity element, the method further comprising, in response to processing the code: verifying, by the browser, that the web application is trustworthy based at least in part on the code and the integrity element for the web application, wherein the request is generated in response to verifying that the web application is trustworthy.

4. The computer-implemented method of claim 3, wherein the integrity element for the web

application comprises an integrity attribute specifying (i) a cryptographic hash function and (ii) a trusted cryptographic hash calculated using the cryptographic hash function and trusted code of the web application.

5. The computer-implemented method of claim 4, wherein verifying, by the browser, that the web application is trustworthy based at least in part on the code and the integrity element for the web application comprises: calculating, by the browser and using the cryptographic hash function, a cryptographic hash of the code for the web application obtained by the browser; determining that the calculated cryptographic hash matches the trusted cryptographic hash by comparing the calculated cryptographic hash to the trusted cryptographic hash; and verifying, by the browser, that the web application is trustworthy in response to determining that the calculated cryptographic hash matches the trusted cryptographic hash, wherein the portion of the integrity element comprises the trusted cryptographic hash.

6. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein modifying the request further comprises inserting, into the request, data identifying a context in which the code is embedded.

7. The computer-implemented method of claim 6, wherein the data identifying the context in which the code is embedded comprises at least one of (i) attributes of a frame of the electronic resource in which the code is embedded or a cryptographic hash of the attributes of the frame.

8. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein the integrity element comprises a digital signature of a web package that includes components of the web application and data identifying the web package.

9. The computer-implemented method of claim 1, wherein the integrity element for the web application comprises an integrity attribute specifying (i) a cryptographic hash function and (ii) a trusted cryptographic hash calculated using the cryptographic hash function and a trusted asset of the web application, wherein the trusted asset comprises an image, logo, or other asset of the web application.

10. A system comprising: one or more processors; and one or more storage devices storing instructions that, when executed by the one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to perform operations comprising: obtaining, by a browser of a client device, an electronic resource comprising code for a web application; rendering, by the browser, the electronic resource, including processing the code of the web application, wherein the code causes the browser to initiate a request to a remote server; in response to processing the code: generating the request; modifying the request to include at least a portion of an integrity element for the web application; and sending the modified request to the remote server; receiving, from the remote server, a response to the request based on the remote server verifying that the web application is trustworthy using the integrity element; and displaying data based on the response, wherein the integrity element comprises a signed approval element comprising a set of integrity data and a digital signature generated based on the set of integrity data, wherein the set of integrity data comprises: a trusted cryptographic hash calculated using a cryptographic hash function and trusted code of the web application; an identity of a trusted signer; and a timestamp indicating a time at which the digital signature is generated, wherein the portion of the integrity element comprises the set of integrity data and the digital signature.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein modifying the request to include the integrity element comprises inserting the portion of the integrity element into a header of the request.

12. The system of claim 10, wherein the electronic resource comprises the integrity element, the operations further comprising, in response to processing the code: verifying, by the browser, that the web application is trustworthy based at least in part on the code and the integrity element for the web application, wherein the request is generated in response to verifying that the web application is trustworthy.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein the integrity element for the web application comprises an integrity attribute specifying (i) a cryptographic hash function and (ii) a trusted cryptographic hash

calculated using the cryptographic hash function and trusted code of the web application.

14. The system of claim 13, wherein verifying, by the browser, that the web application is trustworthy based at least in part on the code and the integrity element for the web application comprises: calculating, by the browser and using the cryptographic hash function, a cryptographic hash of the code for the web application obtained by the browser; determining that the calculated cryptographic hash matches the trusted cryptographic hash by comparing the calculated cryptographic hash to the trusted cryptographic hash; and verifying, by the browser, that the web application is trustworthy in response to determining that the calculated cryptographic hash matches the trusted cryptographic hash, wherein the portion of the integrity element comprises the trusted cryptographic hash.

15. The system of claim 10, wherein modifying the request further comprises inserting, into the request, data identifying a context in which the code is embedded.

16. The system of claim 15, wherein the data identifying the context in which the code is embedded comprises at least one of (i) attributes of a frame of the electronic resource in which the code is embedded or a cryptographic hash of the attributes of the frame.

17. The system of claim 10, wherein the integrity element comprises a digital signature of a web package that includes components of the web application and data identifying the web package.

18. A non-transitory computer readable storage medium carrying instructions that, when executed by one or more processors, cause the one or more processors to perform operations comprising: obtaining, by a browser of a client device, an electronic resource comprising code for a web application; rendering, by the browser, the electronic resource, including processing the code of the web application, wherein the code causes the browser to initiate a request to a remote server; in response to processing the code: generating the request; modifying the request to include at least a portion of an integrity element for the web application; and sending the modified request to the remote server; receiving, from the remote server, a response to the request based on the remote server verifying that the web application is trustworthy using the integrity element; and displaying data based on the response, wherein the integrity element comprises a signed approval element comprising a set of integrity data and a digital signature generated based on the set of integrity data, wherein the set of integrity data comprises: a trusted cryptographic hash calculated using a cryptographic hash function and trusted code of the web application; an identity of a trusted signer; and a timestamp indicating a time at which the digital signature is generated, wherein the portion of the integrity element comprises the set of integrity data and the digital signature.

19. A computer-implemented method comprising: obtaining, by a browser of a client device, an electronic resource comprising (i) code for a web application and (ii) an integrity element for the web application, wherein the integrity element for the web application comprises an integrity attribute specifying (i) a cryptographic hash function and (ii) a trusted cryptographic hash calculated using the cryptographic hash function and trusted code of the web application; rendering, by the browser, the electronic resource, including processing the code of the web application, wherein the code causes the browser to initiate a request to a remote server; in response to processing the code: verifying, by the browser, that the web application is trustworthy based at least in part on the code and the integrity element for the web application, including: calculating, by the browser and using the cryptographic hash function, a cryptographic hash of the code for the web application obtained by the browser; determining that the calculated cryptographic hash matches the trusted cryptographic hash by comparing the calculated cryptographic hash to the trusted cryptographic hash; and verifying, by the browser, that the web application is trustworthy in response to determining that the calculated cryptographic hash matches the trusted cryptographic hash; generating the request in response to verifying that the web application is trustworthy; modifying the request to include at least a portion of the integrity element for the web application, wherein the portion of the integrity element comprises the trusted cryptographic hash; and sending the modified request to the remote server; receiving, from the

remote server, a response to the request based on the remote server; verifying that the web application is trustworthy using the integrity element; and displaying data based on the response.
